

Telecom operators register drop in internet speeds

Top telecom operators Airtel, Vodafone Idea and Reliance Jio have witnessed a major drop in internet speeds in April as indicated by the latest set of data released by the Telecom Regulatory Authority in India. Reliance Jio recorded an average download speed of 13.3 Mbps in April which is a 30% drop in speeds when compared with the average speed in March which stands at 19.5 Mbps.

As most people started working from home due to the Coronavirus lockdown that resulted in a nation-wide lockdown, telecom operators haven't been able to keep up with the surge in demands. Telcos have earlier urged OTT service providers such as Netflix and video services like YouTube to



lower their streaming quality in an attempt to maintain the surge in traffic without sacrificing on bandwidth.

The latest TRAI report indicates that Vodafone Idea registered 5.6 Mbps average download speed followed by Bharti Airtel averaging 5.5 Mbps. In comparison, Vodafone was clocking in 6.7 Mbps average download speed in March while Airtel saw 6.2 Mbps download speeds.

TRAI's data is based on the metrics derived from its MySpeed app that takes into account various elements including data speed, signal strength and more. According to previous data set released by TRAI, Reliance Jio, Airtel and Vodafone witnessed peak performance in February, earlier this year where Jio registered 21.5 Mbps average download speed while Airtel and Vodafone saw average download speeds of 8 Mbps.

TRAI's report on the decline in wired broadband subscribers that was released last month states that the number of wired broadband subscribers stood at 19.14 million at the end of 2019 but witnessed a decline of 0.27% by the end of January 2020.

The report also indicates that the total number of wireless subscribers increased from 1,151 million to 1,156 million at the end of January 2020, registering an increase of 0.43 per cent.

<https://digit.in/speedrop>



NVIDIA Scientist develops open source ventilator

NVIDIA Chief Scientist Bill Dally has created an open-source design of a low-cost ventilator that is also easy to assemble, as a contribution to the global fight against the Novel Coronavirus pandemic. Dally has developed the ventilator in just a few weeks and made it around readily available components.

The ventilator that Dally has designed needs a proportional solenoid valve and a microcontroller. The scientist believes the ventilators can be assembled for a few hundred dollars. The ventilator can also be assembled in a few minutes. It can be attached to a simple display and packed into a Pelican carrying case. The prototype that Dally built was made using off-the-shelf components for \$400 (roughly ₹30,000). When produced in bulk, Dally believes manufacturers can shave off another \$100. If 3D-print parts are used, the whole thing can be manufactured in under \$100, which is quite impressive. According to NVIDIA, the cost of a traditional ventilator is around \$20,000.

Dally has tested the open-source ventilator on a lung simulator, and he has used the same route that NASA recently used to get its own ventilator design approved by the FDA. However, even if the design is approved, finding a manufacturer ready to invest in assembling the parts will be challenging in the current scenario.

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